

THE NOHO RAG: EPISODE 202
OFF TO THE RACES

Written by

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INT. WRITER'S ROOM

Bob flips through binders. Shifts boxes from cubby hole to cubby hole of the bookshelf. Paces. Scratches his head. Then looks over to the desk on the other side of the room.

Sitting lifelessly, OLIVIA stares blankly at Bob.

OLIVIA
Is it five yet?

BOB
We have new anchors now!
(beat)
They will read what you write!
(beat)
They need what you write.
(beat)
They need **you**, Olivia.

OLIVIA
For once!
(beat)
You know how many segments I got on
the air with Alec?

Bob looks with a smirk to the ceiling.

BOB
I was a fan of your game boy
retrospective.

OLIVIA
One!

Bob keeps looking off to the ceiling.

BOB
(sotto)
It really was the best system.

OLIVIA
One, Bob!
(beat)
In almost two years!

Bob looks somberly back at Olivia.

BOB
Well you got your wish. Alec is
gone.
(beat)
But Alec...
(beat)
(MORE)

BOB (CONT'D)
 ... Kinda did all our jobs...
 (beat)
 So now, it's time for us to do the
 jobs we were hired for.
 (beat)
 You know...
 (beat)
 The jobs we're getting paid for?

OLIVIA
 So...
 (beat)
 Does this mean we can cover the
 stories **we** want now?

BOB
 Uhh...
 (beat)
 Sure.

Bob and Olivia nod. Olivia turns back to her desk.

BOB (CONT'D)
 Just no nudity.
 (beat)
 Deal?

Olivia doesn't hear Bob. She obsessively stares at her
 computer screen.

OLIVIA
 At last.
 (beat)
 My reign begins!

SMASH TO: TITLE CARD

INT. NEWS DESK

Dane and Kelly Mae do what they came here to do. News time:

DANE
 Good evening.
 (beat)
 I.
 (beat)
 Am Dane Argyle.

KELLY MAE
 And I'm Kelly Mae Greenblatt.
 (beat)
 (MORE)

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
Tonight NoHo civilians cast their
vote at the polls in the runoff
election to replace Wilson DiNapoli
as the NoHo Comptroller.

(beat)
You may recall DiNapoli from his
surprise resignation a few weeks
ago.

DANE
Ah yes.
(beat)
I recall him dropping a few
expletives as he left, Kelly Mae.

Kelly Mae nods to Dane then addresses the camera:

KELLY MAE
Sixteen candidates fought for your
vote in this runoff election.
(beat)
The two candidates that received
the most votes will now begin their
general election campaigns.

DANE
You mean we'll have to vote again?!

KELLY MAE
Yes, Dane. It said that on the
ballot.

Dane is annoyed.

DANE
(sotto)
But that church smelled weird!

KELLY MAE
We now go live to the first big
winner of the evening. Eugene
Knotts, retired pediatricist and just
a little sweetheart, is preparing
to take the stage.

CUT TO:

INT. CAMPAIGN HEADQUARTERS - ON GREEN

EUGENE KNOTTS is half Don Knotts and half Mr. Rogers. He
stands in suit and tie and attempts to hush cheers.

He begins to remove his suit jacket and reveals a cardigan.

EUGENE
Hello, there!
(beat)
Thank you!
(beat)
Thanks everybody!

Eugene reaches off camera for a warm glass of milk.
He pulls one hand away quickly and shakes it.

EUGENE (CONT'D)
Ooh!
(beat)
Warm!

Eugene addresses the crowd.

EUGENE (CONT'D)
Well, folks!
(beat)
I'm just so happy we did it!
(beat)
We're gonna keep on walking down
this campaign road of ours.
(beat)
And we're gonna win that little old
election later this year...
(beat)
And as your comptroller we're gonna
run this town with steady, measured
and fiscally responsible footsteps!

Audience erupts!

EUGENE (CONT'D)
And as a retired pediatricist, I know
a thing or two about feet.
(beat)
Thank you, guys!

Eugene yawns endearingly.

EUGENE (CONT'D)
Ok, off to bed...

Eugene turns and walks off.

INT. NOHO STUDIOS - NEWS DESK

Two shot.

DANE

Adorable.

(beat)

And now we go to the headquarters
of the other big winner of the
evening, Blake Pearson.

(beat)

Notable for spending a record
amount on his runoff campaign.

INT. CAMPAIGN HEADQUARTERS - GREEN SCREEN

Campaign headquarters is lively. Like a rave. Blake Pearson
takes the stage.

BLAKE

Whoo!

(beat)

Alright NoHo!

The audience calms.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Everybody got your complimentary
vitamin water?

(beat)

Well, raise them high!

(beat)

For today we are victors!

(beat)

And in the upcoming general
election, we will be champions!

(beat)

And to really help kick off our big
campaign, we welcome our new
corporate partner:

A sign squeaks slowly down from the fly space. It shows the
logo of:

BLAKE (CONT'D)

North Victory hotspot and craft
brewing geniuses of the Cahuenga
Valley Brewing Collective!

Cheers.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Now let's launch this big campaign
the best way THIS CANDIDATE know
how:

(beat)

(MORE)

BLAKE (CONT'D)
With victory tote bags, graciously
provided by Fossil.

Blake's voice snaps to a standard Ad Announcer voice:

BLAKE (CONT'D)
For when you first get a day job.
(beat)
Fossil.

INT. NOHO STUDIOS - NEWS DESK

Two shot.

Dane looks at his watch.

DANE
Hmm...
(beat)
Kelly Mae, what exactly is a run
off election?

Kelly Mae turns, almost excited at Dane's banter ability.

KELLY MAE
Well!
(beat)
It's a preliminary election where
the two candidates who get the most
votes then move on to the general
election.
(beat)
So, we'll be seeing a lot more of
those two.

DANE
Ah interesting.
(beat)
Well, run off means something a
little different.
(beat)
To me.

KELLY MAE
Okay.

DANE
And there's nothing preliminary
about it!

KELLY MAE
Dane.

DANE
It just happens.

KELLY MAE
Okay well, from everyone here at
NoHo

DANE
Mostly after a spicy meal.

KELLY MAE
I'm Kelly Mae-

DANE
(sotto)
It **always** burns.

KELLY MAE
Greenblatt.

DANE
And I'm Dane Argyle.
(beat)
Good evening. And good news.

CUT TO:

REVERSE ANGLE OF NEWS DESK

Bob does his standard sigh of relief even though it kind of
ended rocky.

Dane walks past.

DANE
Good show everybody.
(beat)
Take note.
(beat)
That's how you tell the news.

Bob stops Dane at the end of his sentence.

BOB
Dane.

DANE
Yeah, Bob.

BOB
I need to talk to you about how you
tell the news.

DANE
Great!

BOB
Dane.

DANE
Notes for **me**.

BOB
You have to-

DANE
Love it.

BOB
If you would just-

DANE
Love it, Bob!

BOB
Yeah, great.
(beat)
Please avoid colorful references to
bowel movements during the sign
off.
(beat)
Like I've told you...

DANE
Right right.
(beat)
Well, sometimes it just spills out
of me.

BOB
Yeah like that.
(beat)
No more.

DANE
Ten-Four.

Dane walks off.

Bob shakes his head.

EXT. ALLEY BEHIND STUDIO

Kelly Mae walks to her car and begins loading it. Dane
follows shortly there after and sidles up behind her.

DANE
Great job in there.

Dane makes a check in the air.

DANE (CONT'D)
Public: Informed

Kelly Mae spins and faces Dane.

KELLY MAE
Yeah. Informed about your regularly
unpleasant digestive issues.

DANE
Hey. Bob says adlib, I talk about
what I know.

KELLY MAE
Well, learn something else.
(beat)
Scrapbooking.
(beat)
Macramae!
(beat)
Sports!
(beat)
Something! Anything!
(beat)
Just not poop.

DANE
Hmm, they loved it back in Des
Moines.

Kelly Mae does a whole body sigh and drops her head into her
hand.

KELLY MAE
Look Dane, you brought us all the
way out here.

DANE
Big Hollywood News.

KELLY MAE
North Hollywood. Not Hollywood.
Which I'm now learning are two
strikingly different places.

DANE
Still a step up from Des Moines.

KELLY MAE
I was perfectly happy there.

Kelly points at Dane and presses her index finger into his chest.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
You, if you recall, gave a drunken
and damned convincing call to
arms...

Dane looks off to the horizon proudly.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
Made me agree to uproot my life in
Des Moines.

Dane scoffs.

DANE
Life in Des Moines?
(beat)
There wasn't much life to uproot.
(beat)
Look, Leon left you two years ago.
(beat)
Since then, how often have you
broken off plans after work for a
night of white wine and xanax?

Dane grabs Kelly Mae's arms.

DANE (CONT'D)
And we're here!

Dane swings to Kelly Mae's side throws one arm over her shoulder and reaches out his free hand to the horizon.

DANE (CONT'D)
One step closer.
(beat)
To Big.
(beat)
Hollywood.
(beat)
News.

Kelly Mae concedes.

KELLY MAE
Well, it **is** warmer here than Iowa.
(beat)
And there **is** a damn good pie shop
two blocks from my apartment.

DANE
Is that an invitation?

KELLY MAE
I just gotta stop home and let the
dog out.

DANE
Oh, I love the BAJA Men.

Fade to black.